

RENN & SLOANE

TENSION LINE

TWO OUTCASTS.
ONE LINE.
ZERO ROOM
FOR ERROR.



Episode 07: WRECKPOINT DAWN



SCRAP-PENDULUM

DAWN SWINGS.

A SHANTYTOWN CITY
SUSPENDED BY A MILE-LONG
TETHER. BUILT ON A RUSTED
ANCHOR THAT SWINGS ABOVE
THE ENDLESS SEA OF CLOUDS.

AT DAWN, THE TETHER
GLOWS AND THE CITY
BEGINS ITS SWING.

KREEEEEN...

Woom

DOWN IN THE HULL,
LIFE WAKES.

FRESH
GEAR! CHEAP!

TOPSIDE
SPECIAL! YOU
WANT IT, I GOT
IT!

CAREFUL
UP THERE!

ANOTHER
SWING, ANOTHER
DAY.

...

RUSTY'S
REPAIR SHOP!
PATCHES, PARTS,
PROMISES!

THE SWING NEVER
STOPS. NEITHER
DO WE.





SCRAP-PENDULUM

LOWER SCAFFOLDING
COMMERCE PASSAGES
DEPTH: 210m - 380m

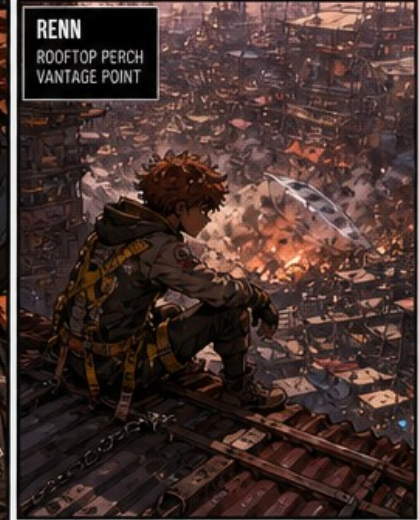
ANCHORITE VANGUARD.

DOWN HERE.
UNGUARDED.
THIS IS...

...MY
JACKPOT.

RENN

ROOFTOP PERCH
VANTAGE POINT



VANGUARD SHIP
"DAUNTLESS"
STATUS: CRITICAL
CREW: UNKNOWN

OBJECTIVE:
SALVAGE ANYTHING
THAT ISN'T NAILED
DOWN.

NOT MUCH LEFT
THAT ISN'T
NAILED DOWN.

STRUCTURAL
INTEGRITY:
COMPROMISED.

HULL BREACHES:
SEVEN AND
COUNTING.

LIFE SIGNS...
DETECTED.

ANCHORITE
CADET.
SLOANE.
STATUS:
UNRESPONSIVE?

SLOANE?

RENN.



RENN.

STEP AWAY
FROM THE SPHERE.
NOW.

WOAH, CAPTAIN
COLDHEART.

NO NEED TO
POINT THAT
AT ME.

I'M JUST
APPRECIATING THE
ARCHITECTURE.

BEAUTIFUL,
ISN'T IT?



HE'S SMILING.

OF COURSE
HE IS.

HE WAS BORN IN
CHAOS. I WAS
RAISED BY ORDER.

AND NOW WE
BOTH STAND IN
THE WRECKAGE.



RELAX,
SLOANE.

I'VE GOT
NOTHING TO
TAKE.

LOOK.

ONLY HERE
TO LOOK.

THAT'S ALL HE
EVER DOES.



THE SPHERE
IS NOT A THING
TO LOOK AT.

IT IS A VAULT.

ITS CONTENTS
COULD RESTORE
THE ANCHORITE
--OR DESTROY IT.

I WON'T GAMBLE
THE HONOR OF THE
VANGUARD ON YOUR
CURIOSITY.



AND I WON'T
GAMBLE MINE.

BESIDES...

IF IT WAS JUST
A VAULT...

YOU WOULDN'T
BE SHAKING.



I SHOULD
HATE HIM.

I SHOULD
TRUST NO
ONE LESS.

SHE STANDS FOR
EVERYTHING
BUILT.

HE MOVES FOR
EVERYTHING
THAT CAN'T BE
CONTAINED.

PRINCIPLE.

IMPROVISATION.

AND YET...

HE'S THE ONE
WHO STILL
MAKES ME
THINK TWICE.

THE SILENCE
WAS NOT GIVEN.

IT WAS TAKEN.

PLUMB-DREADNOUGHT
VESTIGIA-CLASS

**LORD-WARDEN
VALERIUS**
ANCHORITE VANGUARD

HIS DESCENT IS NOT FOR
WAR. IT IS FOR JUDGMENT.
HIS PRESENCE IS NOT FOR
COMFORT. IT IS FOR ORDER.

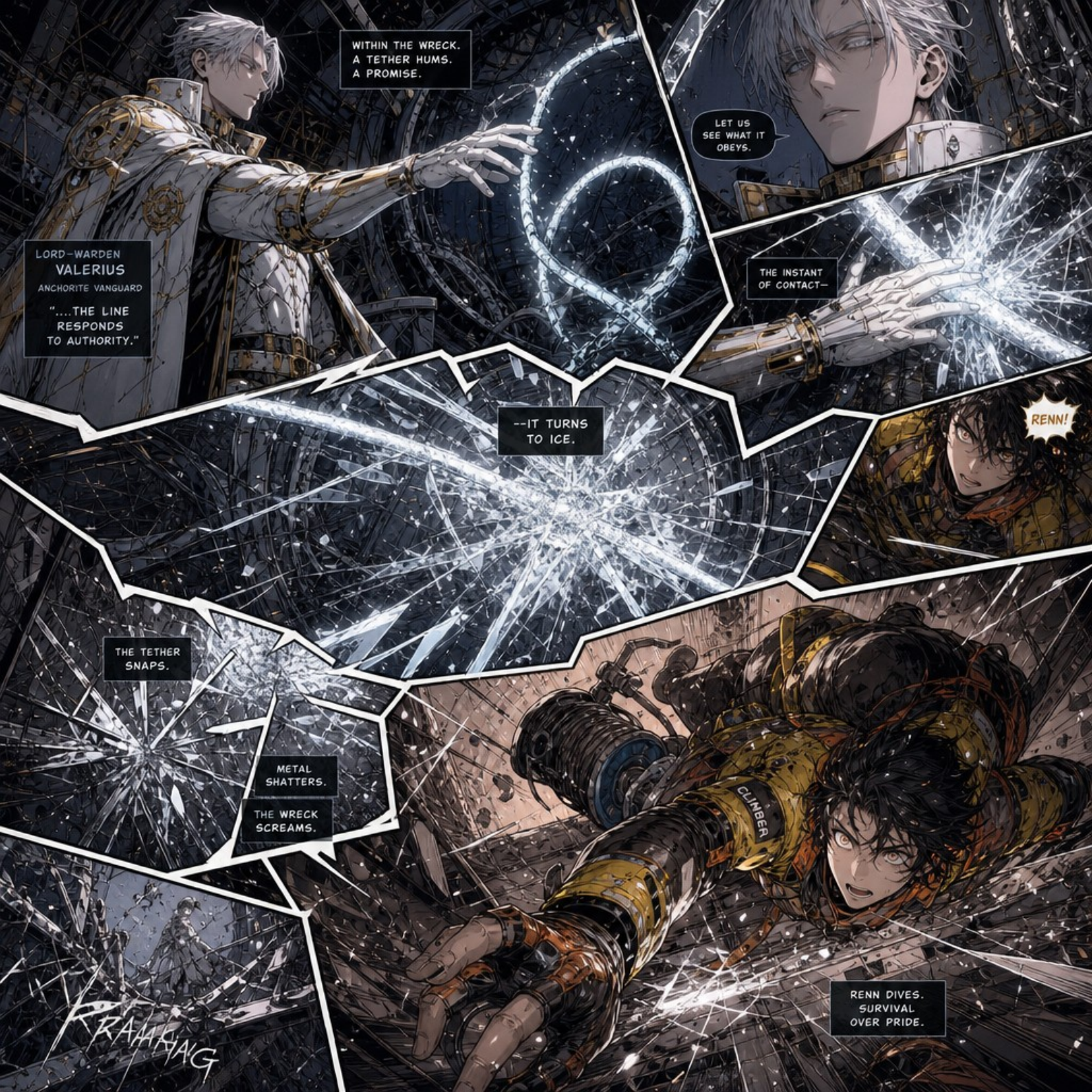
HE DOES NOT
RAISE HIS VOICE.
HE DOES NOT
NEED TO.

HIS FIRST STEP
IS THE LAST
WARNING.

HE DOES NOT
HURRY.

BECAUSE
INEVITABILITY
HAS NO NEED
TO RUSH.

AND NONE
CAN STOP
WHAT IS
INEVITABLE.



WITHIN THE WRECK.
A TETHER HUMS.
A PROMISE.

LORD-WARDEN
VALERIUS
ANCHORITE VANGUARD

"...THE LINE
RESPONDS
TO AUTHORITY."

LET US
SEE WHAT IT
OBEYS.

THE INSTANT
OF CONTACT—

--IT TURNS
TO ICE.

RENN!

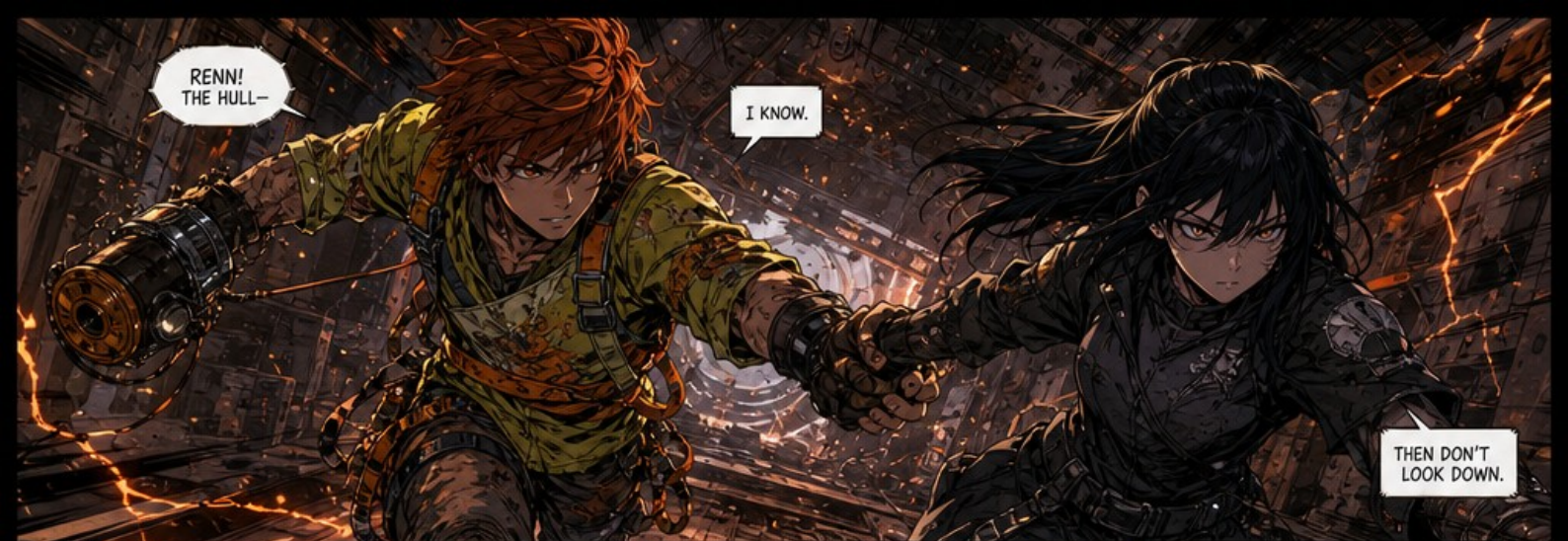
THE TETHER
SNAPS.

METAL
SHATTERS.

THE WRECK
SCREAMS.

RENN DIVES.
SURVIVAL
OVER PRIDE.

RAAAAG



RENN!
THE HULL—

I KNOW.

THEN DON'T
LOOK DOWN.



DON'T LET GO.



IT'S
COMING
APART!

THEN WE
GET OUT
FIRST.

FORGET
THE POD.

WE JUMP.



YOU
READY?

I WAS
BORN READY.

THE TANGLE.

WHERE GRAVITY FORGETS TO BEHAVE.

RENN'S IDEA.
AS USUAL.

HA!
GOTCHA!

PREPARE
FOR
IMPACT.

RUSTED
SWING-CLIPPER.
VEKTOR CLASS.
CREW: SMALL.
TEMPER: WORSE.

WHAT
THE--?!

LOOK
OUT!

THEY'RE ON
THE DECK!

GET THEM
OFF!

SKRANGGG-!!

CUT THE
LINE!

NOT OUR
STYLE.

AAAH!

TOLD YOU-
TANGLE'S GOT
A SENSE OF
HUMOR.

WHAT'S
THE PLAN?
THREE
OPTIONS.

STOLEN SWING-CLIPPER,
UNREGISTERED.
ALTITUDE: INCALCULABLE.
STATUS: EVERY HEARTBEAT
COUNTS.

WE'RE
NOT OUT OF
REACH YET.

UNFAMILIAR
MACHINES.
NO MANUAL.
ALL INSTINCT.
ALL NOW.

COME ON,
OLD GIRL--
WHAT DO YOU
WANT FROM
ME?!

KLAK

CHK-TK

TENSION-GAUNTLET:
ARMED.

WHIRRR

ANCHORITE
CADET.

ROLE:
UNMOVING.

MIND:
SEVEN STEPS
AHEAD.

HSSSSSHH

DISTANCE
IS GROWING.
BUT NOT
ENOUGH.

LORD-WARDEN
VALERIUS.
CALM.
COMPOSED.
RIGHTEOUS.
PATIENT.

HE DOES
NOT CHASE.

HE
DECREES.

HA!
SHE LIKES
THAT!

THUNK

WINCH
ENGAGED!
LINE LOCKED!

WIND-
SHIFTING.
BANKING
IN THREE...

LET THEM
RUN.
THE SKY
IS VAST.
JUSTICE IS
VASTER.



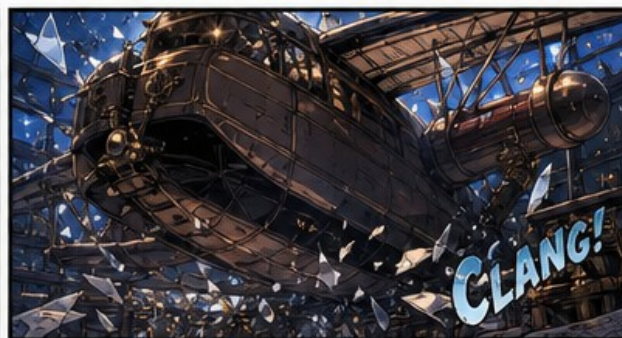
CHAPTER 7:
WHEN
THE STARS
FALL

KRAAASH!!

?!



WH—
WHAT
IN THE—?!



CLANG!

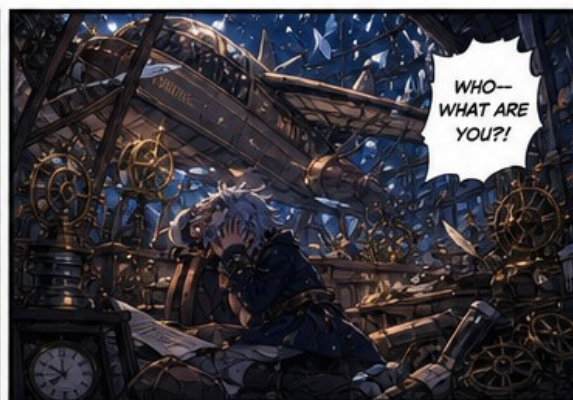


CRACK!

OBSERVATORY,
SEVENTH STATION
"CELESTIA"



NO... NO...
NOT THE
HEMISPHERE
CHARTS!



WHO—
WHAT ARE
YOU?!



**JUST
PASSING
THROUGH!**

R--RENN!
SLOANE!
I--

THE SEISMOGRAPH!
I--I GRABBED IT--
WITHOUT THINKING!

TICK.
TICK.
TICK.

CODA?

YOU'RE
HERE,
TOO?

THIS ISN'T
ABOUT ME.

TICK.
TICK.
TICK.

THIS RECORDS
EVERYTHING.

EVERY SHIFT.
EVERY RUMBLE.
EVERY WARNING.

NO.

WITHOUT IT,
WE'RE BLIND.
WE'RE DEAD.

WITH IT--

WE CAN
UNDERSTAND.
WE CAN
PREPARE.

AND WITH
CODA--

WE CAN
ENDURE.

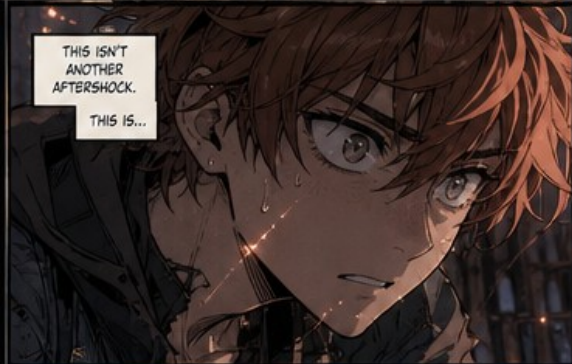
I'LL FIGURE
IT OUT!

I PROMISE!

INTELLECT,
COURAGE.
COMPASSION.

THAT'S HOW WE SURVIVE.

THAT'S HOW
WE WIN.



THE OBSERVATORY
"TWILIGHT WATCH"

THE SHACK IS
BARELY HOLDING.
THE SPIRE BARELY
HOLDS IT.

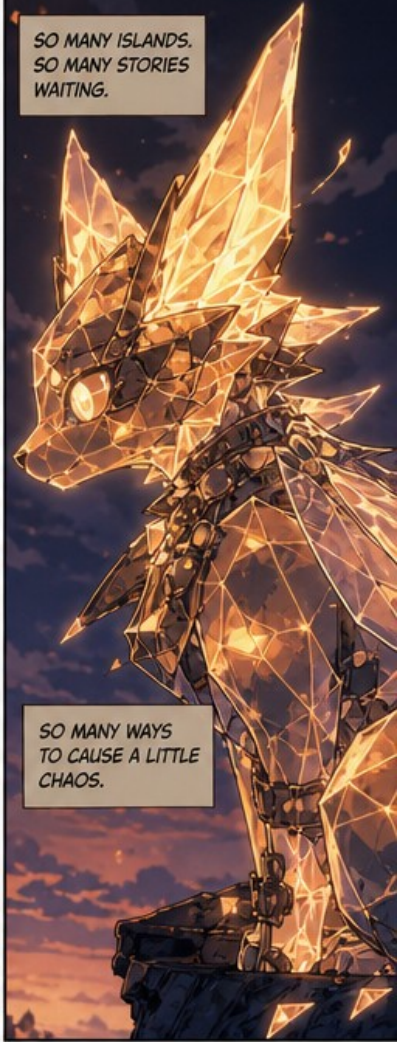


BUT CODA
DOESN'T CARE.



THIS HEIGHT.
THIS WIND.
THIS VIEW.
IT'S PERFECT.

SO MANY ISLANDS.
SO MANY STORIES
WAITING.



SO MANY WAYS
TO CAUSE A LITTLE
CHAOS.



...HM?



A STRAY
CURRENT...
AND FAMILIAR
FOOTSTEPS.

HEH.

YOU'RE LATE,
MACHINE.



...BUT I SAVED
YOU A VIEW.



The stolen vessel
has vanished beyond
the reach of our
finding.

Let it be known:
we do not chase
shadows.



We build.
We endure.

We wait.



The Anchorite
Vanguard does not
act in haste.

We act in
finality.



The horizon
remains.

Empty.
As it should be.



And far below...

...a single Weft-line
unravels.

End of Episode.